



Trim: Build

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<https://omcoda-hq.vercel.app/overview> /// YOU BUILD TIGHTLY WITH THIS METHODOLOGY TO THE T. NO GAPS. You're free to deploy sub-agents to help. Also forget whatever else inside the trim github branches. You build from this dossier and files only

also if you'll probably need access to <https://github.com/bywale-com/omcoda-hq.git>, to have access to same referenced files in the build compendium

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dossier:

Full dossier's in the file. The headlines, and three things that came out of the research that genuinely change the picture:

- *The market is enormous and the gap is measured.** State and local governments collect about \$630 billion a year in property taxes, [The Mortgage Reports](<https://themortgagereports.com/108668/how-to-lower-property-taxes-assessment-appeal>) and up to an estimated 60% of U.S. properties are over-assessed while fewer than 5% of owners appeal, per the National Taxpayers Union Foundation. [Tax Policy Center] (<https://taxpolicycenter.org/briefing-book/how-do-state-and-local-property-taxes-work>) The incumbents prove every layer of the model: Ryan runs ~\$1.2B in revenue [Ryan Tax Firm](<https://ryan.com/practice-areas/property-tax/complex-property-tax/>) at the Fortune-1000 end, and Ownwell just validated the automated end — \$50M Series B, contingency model at ~25% of savings, [Nidoproject](<https://blog.nidoproject.com/ownwell-raises-50-million-to-facilitate-property-tax-appeals-fintech/>) 86% success rate, \$774

average annual savings per customer. [Crunchbase News]
(<https://news.crunchbase.com/venture/ownwell-raise-lower-homeowner-property-tax/>) The open segment is the middle: small/mid commercial and multifamily, 1–20 parcels — too small for Ryan's cost structure, too complex for a homeowner funnel, \$2–15K per parcel per year in fees.

- ***Finding 1 — the acquisition layer has a legal gatekeeper.*** Texas's consultant ethics code says a registrant shall not solicit or advertise property tax consulting services by claiming a specific result. [Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation]
(<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/news/rulemaking/2026/06/23/notice-of-intent-to-review-rules-8/>) That rule sits ***directly on top of the ALG notice*** — "you're overpaying \$14K, click to fix it" may literally be illegal solicitation in Texas as phrased. The compliant shape is analysis-not-promise ("assessed at \$X, evidence supports \$Y"). That's the #1 SME question, because it constrains the exact mechanism that makes this ALG.
- ***Finding 2 — the licensed-person-of-record pattern again, harder.*** Texas requires individual registration (exam + 40 classroom hours), and caps sponsorship at 10 registered consultants per senior consultant [texas]
(<https://capitol.texas.gov/tlodocs/81R/analysis/html/HB02591E.htm>) — meaning Trim's capacity in Texas literally scales in units of licensed humans. Same class as Illinois's finder license, but with a structural ratio attached.
- ***Finding 3 — the first genuine Worker seat since Tally.*** Formal appeals get argued at hearings before lay boards, in person in many jurisdictions. That's a per-hearing, bounded, local, pay-per-appearance unit of work — pick up a prepared case packet, attend, argue, report. It passes your Tally test exactly: without that seat, value creation stops at the formal level. Which means Trim isn't just another ALG outcome — it's the first place Tally's Worker mechanics could be ***reused*** rather than reinvented. The T-line converging on itself.

Name held: ****Trim.****

- ****SUPPORTING DOCS****

Trim — Property Tax Over-Assessment Recovery: Full Dossier

- Prepared for seed-crafting. Every factual claim carries its source inline. Items marked NEEDS VERIFICATION are not yet safe to treat as settled.*

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1. The outcome, stated plainly

Property is taxed on its assessed value. Assessors mass-appraise millions of parcels on a cycle; mass appraisal produces errors; errors skew high often enough that the National Taxpayers Union Foundation estimates up to 60% of U.S. properties are over-assessed while fewer than 5% of owners ever appeal (themortgagereports.com citing NTUF). Every jurisdiction provides a formal appeal process with a fixed filing window. A successful appeal reduces the assessment, which reduces the tax bill by (reduction × local tax rate), every year until the next reassessment. The service: detect the over-assessment from public data, tell the owner what they're overpaying, get one authorization, run the appeal, take a cut of the measured savings.

- *The eligibility fact is public and specific before contact** — assessment rolls, comparable sales, and (in equity-argument states) neighboring parcels' assessments are all public record. A specific parcel's over-assessment and estimated annual overpayment can be computed with zero input from the owner. This is the same physics as Trove B2B: the fact exists before the relationship does.

2. Market

- Total U.S. property tax collected: **~\$630B/year** (Statista, 2021 state+local; Tax Policy Center confirms \$630B 2021, \$609B local).
- Non-residential (commercial/industrial) share of property tax paid has historically run **~56%** of collections (Tax Foundation, FY2010 analysis) — commercial carries a disproportionate share of the levy (in NYC: 21.3% of market value, 38.8% of the levy — White & Williams).
- The over-assessment gap is the product: up to 60% over-assessed, under 5% appealing (NTUF). Ownwell's own survey: 74% of homeowners worried about property taxes, only 22% have ever appealed (HousingWire).
- The services industry this feeds is already large: **Ryan LLC alone runs ~\$1.2B revenue** (ZoomInfo) with ~800 property-tax professionals across 41 North American offices, the largest commercial practice (ryan.com). O'Connor claims **\$213M saved for clients in 2025** (cutmytaxes.com). Ownwell has

processed ****1M+ appeals****, saved customers ****\$400M+****, reports ****86% success rate**, \$774 average annual savings per residential customer******, and just raised a ****\$50M Series B (\$74M total)**** at 25% contingency (Crunchbase, PRNewswire, VentureBurn, Inman).

- A single commercial example of unit economics: a property assessed at \$2.8M against \$2.3M market value $\approx$ ****\$16K/year in excess tax**** (UGBB Law, Missouri example). At 30–40% contingency on first-year savings, one mid-size commercial win $\approx$ \$5–6K fee; portfolios multiply this.
- ***Segment structure (this determines who to serve):****
- ***Fortune 1000 / complex industrial:*** owned by Ryan, Altus, big law. Relationship-sold, multi-year engagements. Not the entry point.
- ***Residential mass-market:*** Ownwell, O'Connor, and letter-mail players (Owlue). Low ACV ($\$774 \text{ avg} \times 25\% \approx \$190/\text{customer/yr}$ for Ownwell), won on volume + ad spend.
- ****The gap: small/mid commercial and multifamily — owners of 1–20 parcels.**** Too small for Ryan's relationship model, too complex for a homeowner signup funnel (income-approach valuation, entity ownership, higher stakes). ACV per parcel in the \$2–15K range at standard contingency. This is the Tally-ACV-floor-compatible segment and the natural first wedge.

3. Physics of the appeal (the actual process)

1. ****Assessment cycle.**** Most states reassess annually; others every 2–5 years (CBIZ). Notice-of-value mailings open a fixed appeal window per jurisdiction (e.g., Missouri BOE: second Monday in July; Texas: generally May 15 / 30 days from notice).
2. ****Detection.**** Compare assessed value against market evidence: sales comps (residential/simple commercial), income approach (income-producing commercial — cap rate on NOI), and equity/uniformity arguments (Texas "equal and uniform": your parcel vs. comparable parcels' assessments — arguable entirely from public data).
3. ****Appeal ladder.**** Informal review with the assessor → formal hearing before a lay board (Appraisal Review Board / Board of Equalization / Value Adjustment

Board, names vary) → judicial appeal or binding arbitration above that (O'Connor's three-phase framing). Most volume resolves at informal/formal levels.

4. **Evidence.** Comps package, income statements (commercial), photos/condition, uniformity tables. Ownwell's model: automated evidence generation from public records, human agents at hearings.

5. **Resolution.** Reduction granted (fully or partially) or denied. Savings = reduction × millage rate, realized on the next tax bill. **The money never moves through the service provider** — the win is a smaller bill from the county.

6. **Recurrence.** Assessments reset on the next cycle; many jurisdictions quietly re-raise. O'Connor's whole retention model is "we protest your taxes year after year, once you sign up" (poconnor.com) — the authorization persists, detection re-fires annually, and the appeal re-runs. Built-in recurring revenue on a single signature.

4. The zero-risk architecture (how the money works)

- **Owner's risk: zero by industry convention.** Contingency-only is the established norm — no upfront fee, no fee on loss (Paramount, Tax Appeal Consultants, FTAPS, Ownwell all state this). Deviation from it would be a red flag; conformance to it costs nothing because it's already the shape of the business.
- **No escrow question.** There is no fund to hold, no client money in flight, ever. The "recovery" arrives as a reduced bill from the county. Trim's fee is an invoice against measured, documented savings (assessment before/after × rate — verifiable from public record, which makes the invoice itself provable from the same public data the detection came from).
- **Collection risk exists and is the mirror of Trove B2B's:** the client realizes the benefit (lower bill) before paying the fee. Dunning/collections process required; no deduction-at-source possible. Mitigations: card/ACH authorization captured at signing (charge on documented reduction), and the annual-recurrence relationship — an owner who stiffs the fee loses next year's protest. NEEDS DESIGN, not verification — this is a known structural fact.
- **One small caveat to "purely zero-cost":** some jurisdictions charge filing fees (FL VAB example: ~\$20/folio, which FTAPS passes through). Decide:

absorb (cleaner story) or pass through (industry-accepted). Absorbing preserves the pure zero-risk claim at trivial cost.

- **Residential wrinkle:** most homeowners pay property tax through mortgage escrow, so "savings" arrive as an escrow adjustment months later — dilutes the felt win and complicates fee timing. One more reason the commercial/multifamily wedge (direct payers) is first.

5. Why this could beat the incumbents

- **Ryan/big-firm flank:** they are relationship-sold, human-heavy (\$1.2B revenue ÷ 800 professionals ≈ \$1.5M/professional — a services cost structure), and economically uninterested in sub-\$50K-fee accounts. Trim's automation floor makes the \$2–15K/parcel segment profitable at scale; Ryan's cost structure makes it unservable. No collision for years.
- **Ownwell/O'Connor flank (the real fight):** they've validated demand, contingency, and automation — Ownwell just proved investors will fund exactly this thesis (\$50M, Feb 2026, Intuit Ventures on the cap table). But study their acquisition motion: **ads + mail + a signup funnel.** Ownwell's flow is still self-serve onboarding — visit site, enter address, create account, sign. Owlue's letters carry the parcel-specific numbers but funnel into the same "call us / sign up" step — and are drawing "is this a scam?" coverage (Claims Maximizer's whole article exists because recipients can't tell). Nobody serves the account itself in the first touch. The ALG difference, concretely:
- **Their motion:** compute over-assessment → advertise/mail → prospect visits site → self-onboards → signs → appeal runs → portal.
- **Trim's motion:** compute over-assessment → **serve the account** (link opens their instance: parcel, evidence preview, estimated overpayment, verifiable against the county's own site) → one authorization → appeal runs → instance + agent carry the relationship; detection re-fires every year inside the standing account.

The wedge isn't better appeals — Ownwell's 86% is fine and appeal outcomes are board-dependent anyway. The wedge is **CAC and activation**: no funnel to fall out of, trust built by verifiability rather than brand ads, and the commercial segment (where Ownwell's homeowner UX doesn't fit and Ryan won't stoop) as first territory. Plus the recurrence lock: once the authorization stands, every future

cycle's detection → protest happens inside the instance with zero re-acquisition cost — the same dynamic O'Connor exploits, minus O'Connor's onboarding.

- *Honest counter-case (what would make this fail):** Ownwell pivots down-funnel into serve-first mechanics faster than Trim stands up (they have the data corpus and \$50M); or commercial owners prove unreachable by async channels and demand the relationship-sales motion after all; or per-county data acquisition costs (3,000+ counties, wildly inconsistent roll formats) eat the automation margin. These are the three real bets being made.

6. Assumptions register (each one load-bearing; test in this order)

1. **Detection confidence is high enough to state a number in the first touch.** The notice must say "over-assessed by ~\$X" and survive both (a) the owner checking the county's own site and (b) solicitation-advertising law. Texas TDLR's code of ethics prohibits soliciting property-tax-consulting services "by claiming a specific result" (TDLR 010PTC) — **this directly constrains the notice copy in Texas and any state with an equivalent rule.** The compliant shape is likely "your assessment is \$X; comparable evidence supports \$Y; estimated excess ≈ \$Z, subject to appeal outcome" — framed as analysis, not promised result. NEEDS VERIFICATION per state; this is the #1 SME question because it sits exactly on the ALG acquisition mechanism.

2. **A one-time authorization enables filing and representation.** True and standardized in the big markets — Texas has a literal state form (Appointment of Agent, Form 50-162); other states use their own agent-authorization instruments. The Trove B2B officer-signature gate, again, with the same "who may sign for an entity" question.

3. **Representation is licensed, per state, at the person level.** Texas: registered Property Tax Consultant under Occupations Code Ch. 1152 — exam + 40 classroom hours, individual registration, senior-consultant sponsorship structure, max 10 consultants per senior (TDLR; SB 1870 analysis). Other states range from open (anyone with authorization) to attorney-preferred/required at judicial levels. This is the Illinois-finder-of-record pattern: **a licensed human of record on Trim's side, per state**, whose name is on filings. Rollout sequence gates on this exactly like Trove B2B's finder registration.

4. **Hearings need a human presence in most formal-level jurisdictions.** Boards hear evidence from parties in person or (increasingly, post-2020) remotely/by affidavit. Even where remote/written is allowed, formal hearings are argued by someone. **This creates the first genuine Worker-shaped seat since Tally:** per-hearing, bounded, local, pay-per-appearance advocacy — pick up a prepared case file, attend, argue the packet, report result. NEEDS VERIFICATION on the remote/written share by jurisdiction, because it sets how big the Worker layer needs to be vs. how much resolves at informal (no-hearing) levels.

5. **Income-approach commercial appeals need owner data.** The strongest commercial cases use the property's actual income/expenses — not public. Detection can still fire from sales-comp and uniformity evidence (public), but the ***best*** case sometimes requires the owner to upload a rent roll / P&L. This softens "zero information needed" into "zero information needed to know you're overpaying; optional documents to maximize the win" — a Documents-module fact, same as Trove B2B's merger-proof conditional upload.

6. **Per-county data plumbing is the real moat-or-grave.** Assessment rolls, comp data, appeal calendars, and e-filing capability vary across thousands of counties. Ownwell's six-year corpus ("hundreds of thousands of appeals... figuring out what wins" — Crunchbase) is their actual asset. Trim's launch discipline: deepest-value counties first (Texas metros are the canonical wedge — annual cycle, equal-and-uniform doctrine, consultant licensure regime, no state income tax so property tax is the fight that matters), not breadth.

7. **Fee caps are not the constraint here that they were in unclaimed property** — market rates run 25–50% of first-year savings openly (countrytaxcalc; Ownwell at 25%). But consultant-conduct law (contract requirements, solicitation rules, fictitious-protest prohibitions — the exact abuses SB 1870/HB 2591 legislated against in Texas) is. Different regulatory center of gravity, same jurisdiction-registry architecture.

7. SME roster (the ten seats for this domain)

1. **Licensed property tax consultant (practitioner)** — e.g., a Texas TDLR Senior PTC. Knows what actually wins at informal vs. ARB, evidence norms, county-by-county temperament. The recovery-claims-specialist equivalent.

2. **Valuation/mass-appraisal specialist (IAAO-literate appraiser)** — sales comparison, income approach, cost approach, assessment ratios, uniformity

statistics. Owns detection-model credibility: when is "over-assessed by \$X" defensible.

3. ****Representation-rules & licensure specialist**** — per state: who may represent (consultant / agent / attorney-only, by appeal level), individual-registration regimes, sponsorship structures (TX's 10-per-senior rule), entity-signature rules. The finder-registration equivalent; gates rollout order.

4. ****Solicitation & advertising compliance specialist**** — TDLR ethics rules ("no specific result" claims), state consumer-protection law on unsolicited tax-services outreach, mail/text/email channel rules. ****Owns the legality of the ALG notice itself**** — the acquisition layer's gatekeeper.

5. ****Appraisal-district / board-perspective specialist**** — former assessor's-office or ARB/BOE member. What evidence formats boards accept, scheduling mechanics, remote/written-hearing availability, what irritates vs. persuades a lay board.

6. ****Judicial-appeal / arbitration attorney**** — the layer above the board: binding arbitration (TX), tax court, when escalation is worth it, fee-shifting rules. Also the "attorney-only state" boundary-drawer.

7. ****County-data specialist**** — assessment-roll formats, CAMA systems, comp-data availability, e-file portals, FOIA/open-records fallbacks, per-county acquisition cost. Feeds CTO directly but the knowledge is domain, not engineering.

8. ****Mortgage-servicing/escrow specialist**** — how reductions flow through escrowed accounts (timing, escrow analysis cycles), relevant the moment residential enters; also relevant to multifamily owners with lender-held tax escrows.

9. ****Tax/accounting treatment specialist**** — is the refund/reduction taxable to a business (expense reduction vs. income), 1099 handling on Trim's fee, how owners book multi-year savings. Same seat as Trove B2B's #8, different answers.

10. ****Trust/anti-scam perception specialist**** — the Owlue letters are already generating "is this a scam?" explainers (Claims Maximizer). Same four-element trust kit as Trove B2B: named county + parcel ID, county-site verification link, explicit non-affiliation disclaimer (likely legally required in TX-style regimes: "shall

not state or imply that the registrant represents a person or firm that the registrant does not"), no-upfront-fee statement.

8. Value chain & the persona test (run his test, not the org-chart test)

- *Chain: always-on detection over assessment rolls → serve → authorize once → appeal prepared → hearing argued → reduction lands on the bill → invoice the cut → detection re-fires next cycle.**

Seats in the chain: **Owner** (one account per owning entity, portfolio of parcels inside it — delegates/CFO/counsel are features of the account, not personas). **Operator** (agency cockpit over all owner instances; onboards in the OLG case; oversees detection, outreach, jurisdiction gates, collections, audit — same cockpit-over-instances architecture as Trove B2B). **Licensed agent-of-record** (per-state human whose license the filings run under — compliance fact on Trim's side, tracked, not a full product persona). **Worker — the real candidate:** per-hearing local advocates who pick up prepared case packets and argue them at boards. This passes the Tally test — without the hearing seat, value creation literally stops at the formal level in in-person jurisdictions — making Trim the first outcome since Tally with a genuine marketplace-shaped Worker layer, and the first place the Tally Worker mechanics (available → pick up → active → done, pay-per-unit) could be *reused* rather than reinvented. Agent threads through every view as always: presentation only, scoped per instance.

9. Name

- *Trim** — it's what the product does to the tax bill, it's one syllable, and the verb survives daily use ("Trim found \$14K on the Lamar Street building"). Keeps the T-line: Tower, Tally, Trove, Trim.

10. What goes into the seed that this dossier now makes possible

Market + mechanism + money (sections 1–4), the incumbent map and the wedge (5), the assumptions register as open questions the SMEs must close (6), the ten-seat roster (7), the chain with the Worker seat flagged as a genuine persona (8) — plus the standing Omcode laws (one account per business, operator as agency cockpit, agent as scoped mouth of each instance, automation as the engine, UI always full). The conversation trace from Trove B2B carries forward as method-context: same front-page format, SME Pass 1 (sourced questions) → Pass 2 (draft

answers) → cross-cuts → PM/CTO with reconciliation checkpoint → full process to prototype.

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for any reason if you can't access the build methodology by the website, you also have access to the gitrepo directly and should probably use that to pull canonical structures. You won't need to invent a register or code base behind a register. You have access to the repo:

Good luck